

Beginning

Once Beijing's first residential building fitted with elevators—a coveted address that countless people dreamed of calling home—Fusui Jing Building now stands dilapidated and vacant. It has even earned a spot on the list of the "Four Haunted Buildings in the Capital" thanks to its eerie folk legends, and served as the inspiration for multiple film adaptations. What untold story lies behind this structure? Let us now lift the veil on its mysterious past.



Haunted Room



Related Movie



Picture from 1958



Great Leap Forward



Constution

Constructed in 1958 as a product of the Great Leap Forward, the Fusui Jing Building—once a renowned landmark also called the "People's Commune Building" and "Communist Building"—ceased operation in 2005. A hallmark of that era was its communal canteens, where the collective "common pot" dining practice was widely promoted. Residents admitted to the building had to pass strict political screening; with about 40 households per floor, it housed 358 families in total.

Cultural Revolution



Be Haunted

It was rumored that in 1967, a lady living in the building committed suicide by jumping off the building under immense pressure due to her "alleged moral misconduct". Since then, tales of hauntings have circulated. The controversial memories left by that specific historical period lacked official channels for public discussion and clarification. As a result, ordinary people vented their complicated emotions toward the past indirectly by making up tragic stories associated with the building, which thus became a vessel for emotional projection.

Present



Be Abandoned

As time went on, these unsubstantiated tales drifted further away from historical facts, and "haunted building" became a synonym for the structure. Especially after the building was vacated and left unused in 2005 due to fire risks, its dilapidated state from years of neglect lent greater credibility to the rumors. Eventually, the moniker "Ghost Eight-Story Building" replaced its original name "Fusui Jing Building" and became its most widely recognized identifier.

After the renovation



Be Saved

In 2019, the Fusui Jing Building was officially listed as a historical protected structure. To rescue this abandoned edifice and inject new vitality into it, I aspire to transform it into a new public building through adaptive renovation. While enabling it to serve new functions, the project also aims to revive and encourage people to confront that once-taboo period of history embedded within its walls.

